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14 Jul 52 NORFOLK VA

14/2012 EST
15/0112 Z

XXXX

2 Airline pilots

Air

12 sec 6 XX

Six disc-shaped objects, 100 ft in diameter, emitting a reddish glow, approached the airliner at approx 2000'. Objects made erratic turn to avoid collision, sped away in original formation.

1. Five jet a/c were in the vicinity of Langley AFB at this time.

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NBR 59 AIR 29 16 JULY 1952

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RE JEPHQ 61C

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FM HQ USAF WASH 25 DC

TO JEDEN/CGAIRDEFCOM ENT AFB COLO

JEDWP/CG AMC WRIGHT-PATTERSON AFB OHIO

JEPLG/CG TAC LANLEY AFB VA

Cite

/CONFIDENTIAL/RQM AFOIN 53722 CRYPTOPRECAUTION APPLIES TH FOLLOWING CABLE FROM 7TH DIS OSI (IG) MACDILL AFB FLA IS QUOTED FOR YOUR INFORMATION. QUOTE-EIGHT UNINENTIFIED LUMINOUS CIRCULAR OBJECTS FLYING IN FORMTION, VICINITY LANGLEY AFB VA SIGHTED BY CAPT FRANK KOEPKE, PILOT PAN AMERICAN AIRWAYS WHILE ON NEW YORK-SAN JUAN FLIGHT. OBJECTS SIGHTED 14 JULY 52, AT APPROX 2100 HRS. WITNESSED BY W B NASH, CO-PILOT AND BILL FRONTENBERY, ENGINEER. CREW MEMBERS STATED CIRCULAR OBJECTS TURNED TO AVOID COLLISION WITH AIRLINER. ESTIMATED SPEED 1-THOUSAND MILES PER HOUR. CREW MEMBERS BEING ITERVIEWED BY OSI AT MIAMI ,FLAS

16/1430Z JULY JEZPHQ

525-78275-1

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DOD DIR 5200.10

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AF FORM 112—PART I
APPROVED 1 JUNE 1948

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(1)

COUNTRY United States	REPORT NO WOINT# 3-52	(LEAVE BLANK) AF 479620

AIR INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

SUBJECT Sighting of Unconventional Aircraft	
AREA REPORTED ON Chesapeake Bay	FROM (AGENCY) Wing Intelligence Office, 435th Troop Carrier Wing (M), MIA, Miami, Fla.

DATE OF REPORT 15 July 1952	DATE OF INFORMATION 14 July 1952	EVALUATION B-2

PREPARED BY (OFFICER) Major John H. Sharpe	SOURCE PAA Pilots

REFERENCES (Control number, directive, previous report, etc., as applicable)

SUMMARY: (Enter concise summary of report. Give significance in final one sentence paragraph. List inclosures at lower left. Begin text of report on AF Form 112 - Part II.)

1. On 15 July 1952, the undersigned, with the local OSI Chief Agent, debriefed two PAA pilots who had sighted a formation of eight (8) unconventional flying objects over Chesapeake Bay near Old Point Comfort on the night of 14 July 1952. The written statement of the two pilots is attached. An overlay showing the path and direction of the "saucers" is also attached.

2. The pilots were W. B. Nash of 400 Ridgewood Road, Biscayne Key, Miami 49, Florida and W. H. Fortenberry of 360 N.W. 130 Street, Miami, Florida. Both men are apparently of high integrity and above average intelligence. Both are pilots of several years experience.

John H Sharpe
JOHN H. SHARPE
Major, USAF
Wing Intelligence Officer

w/2 incls (1-2)
ATISD 1ef
5 Aug 52

2 INCLS
1. Statement of Pilots
2. Overlay - Path & Direction

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ATIC 74203

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AIR INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

FROM (Agency) Wing Intelligence Office,
435th Troop Carrier Wing (M), MIA
Miami, Florida

REPORT NO.

PAGE 2 OF 3 PAGES

1. The DC-4 piloted by Nash and Fortenberry was approaching Norfolk, Virginia, about six minutes (20-25 miles) out on the NE leg of the range, at 8,000 feet, when six saucers were first spotted over Hampton Roads or the city of Newport News, approaching the aircraft on a heading of about 60°, at about 2,000 feet. When they reached a point under and slightly to the right of the DC-4, Fortenberry who was in the righthand seat observed them roll up on edge and, not making a turn in an arc, instantly shoot off on a heading of 270°, rolling back to a flat position. This change of direction was made with the suddenness of a bullet ricocheting off a stone wall and was not a turn in the sense that conventional aircraft make a turn. Immediately after the change of direction two more of the discs appeared from behind and to the right of the DC-4 and joined the formation.

2. The speed of the discs was estimated at well over 1,000 mph. When first seen, they were glowing on the top side with an intense amber-red light many times more brilliant than the lights of the cities below, and resembling a glowing red-hot coal. Their diameter was approximately 100 ft. (estimated) and they appeared perfectly circular. They approached the DC-4 in a narrow echelon formation, almost in trail, and appeared to decelerate just before changing direction. With the deceleration was noted a dimming of their intense glow, and immediately after changing direction and flattening out, the glow disappeared entirely. They reappeared at once, glowing brilliantly again, and began climbing on a heading of 270°. Their glow was extinguished again, this time in sequence rather than simultaneously, and they were lost to view.

3. The following impressions were received by Nash and Fortenberry and are of interest:

a. The saucers were in a controlled formation, and during deceleration prior to the change of direction they did not hold perfect formation, but some almost overran the leader. After the turn they were again in good formation.

b. The glow or light on the top surface was related to the power source, since in deceleration the light dimmed, and apparently brightened when power was again applied.

c. Thickness of the objects was estimated at ten to fifteen feet by Nash and at not enough to accomodate a man standing erect, by Fortenberry.

d. The objects did not respond to natural laws, and appeared weightless. They were not affected by gravity or momentum since they changed direction 150° without turning or coming to a stop.

e. No physical characteristics were noticeable except as already mentioned. The light on top of the saucers was internal and not projected, since it was not reflected off the DC-4.

f. The light did not pulse but was steady, and the objects were sharply outlined. There was no corona or hazy periphery surrounding them. The dimming was as if by rheostat, or reduction of power. They also went completely off instantly and instantly reappeared.

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AF FORM 112—PART II
APPROVED 1 JUNE 1948

(3)

AIR INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

FROM (Agency) Wing Intelligence Office, 435th Troop Carrier Wing (M), MIA Miami, Florida	REPORT NO.	PAGE 3 OF 3 PAGES

g. The objects are definitely not of earthly origin.

COMMENTS of Preparing Officer:

1. The observers are considered reliable, and evidently saw just what they described. The objects were in view for at least five seconds, possibly ten seconds, since Nash saw them approaching, got out of the left seat, crossed to the other side of the cockpit and picked them up again as they completed their turn and watched them disappear.

2. Assuming that they were in view ten miles before the turn and ten miles after the turn and that ten seconds elapsed in this period, the discs covered twenty miles in ten seconds, a speed fantastic to contemplate.

John H. Sharpe
JOHN H. SHARPE
Major, USAF
Wing Intelligence Officer

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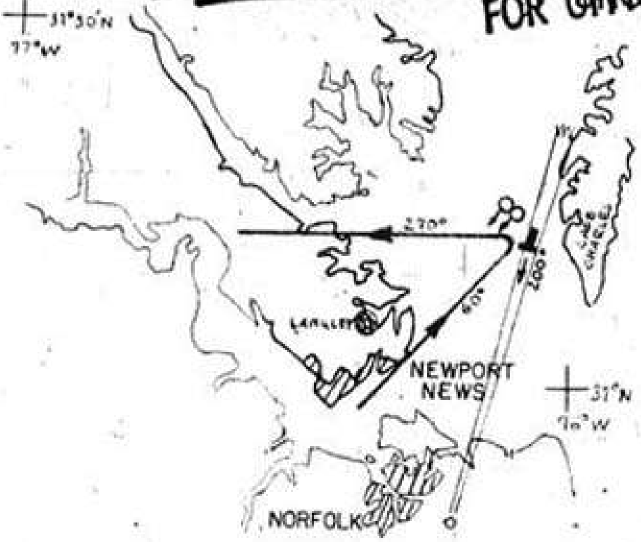

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ATIC 74203-2

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CASE #11

15 July 1952 Norfolk, Virginia

A DC-4 type a/c MF.88901, piloted by 2 airline pilots, was approaching Norfolk, Virginia, about 20-25 miles out on the NE leg of the range, at 8,000' when 6 unidentified objects were first sighted approaching a/c on a heading of about 60 deg at approximate 2,000'. When the objects reached a point under & slightly to the right of the a/c, one of the observers saw them roll up on edge and, not make a turn banked 90° in an arc, instantly shoot off on a heading of 270 deg, rolling back to a flat position. climbed and disappeared This change of direction was made with the suddenness of a bullet ricocheting off a stone wall after the change of direction two more of the objects appeared from behind and to the right of the DC-4 and joined formation. at 2012.

The speed of the discs was estimated at well over 1,000 mph. When first seen, they were glowing on the top side with an intense amber-red light, and resembling a glowing red hot coal. Their diameter was approximately 100' (estimated) and they appeared to be perfectly circular. They approached the DC-4 in a narrow echelon formation, almost in trail, and appeared to decelerate just before changing direction. With the deceleration a dimming of their intense glow was noted, and immediately after changing direction and flattening out, the glow disappeared entirely. They reappeared at once, glowing brilliantly again, and began climbing on a heading of 270 deg. Their glow was extinguished again, this time in sequence rather than simultaneously, and they were lost from view.

ATIC Comments: Five jet a/c were in the vicinity of Langley AFB at the time of observation. After various checks with surrounding AF agencies, it was concluded that objects were not the 5 jet a/c. Other checks for known airborne objects were made with negative results. Sighting occurred at 2012 EST on 14 July 1952 for a period of 15 seconds.

Conclusion:

Unknown